How the place got its name also has various theories. A few are mentioned below:

a) The place existed before Zoroastrianism and the tradition of idol-worship called samīna was prevalent. This led to the name Semnan.
b) Scythians had established a settlement in ancient times which went on to be called Sakanān by Iranians.
c) According to the Islamic narratives of locality, the two sons of Prophet Noah, Sim An-Nabi and Lam An-Nabi were the first settlers of Semnan. They say that it is from these two names that Simlan came that over time the turned into Semnan.
d) Some say that Semnan was established by the mythical character Tahmuras (in Ferdowsi's epic poem, the Shahnameh), who had named his city Saminā.
e) We have a narrative that there existed an ancient language called *Sa ma nān*, and people named their city after it.
f) We hear of a Sermani tradition wherein women cooked breads amounting to three months in a day. The phrase *sa ma nān* meant 'three months of bread.' Hence a few postulate that name comes from this Sermani tradition.

10 Al-Hidayah fi Sharh Bidayat al-Mubtadi (593 AH/AD 1197) commonly referred to as al-Hidayah (lit. 'the guidance', also spelled Hedaya), is a twelfth century legal manual by Burhan al-Din al-Margilali, which is one of the most influential compendia of Hanafi jurisprudence (fiqh). It has been subject of numerous commentaries. The book played a key role in the development and amalgamation of Islamic and British law known as Anglo-Muhammadan law.

11 Esfara, is a district in the Fergana valley to the south of the Jaxartes extending to the foothills of the Turkistan (Bottamān) range. The city of the same name in Tajikistanstands 107 km east of Ḵojand on the Esfara River, which is used extensively for irrigation.

Esfara (also Espara, Esfarah, Esbara, Asbara) should not be mistaken with Asfara/Asbara of southern Kazakhstan, reconstructed as Ašpara following A shi bu lai in the Chinese sources (Minorsky, 1937) (Chavannes, 1903). 'Asfara'is also noted as the name of a local Sogdian prince, the heir apparent to the king of Fergana, who controlled the rural district of Esfara, where he resettled the Sogdians in AD 721–22 who had emigrated eastward to avoid conversion to Islam. The district was known then as the Pass of 'Esâām after 'Eṣām, born as 'Abd-Allāh al-Bāhelī, who had been appointed as governor there by Qotayba b. Moslem (Gibb, 1923) (Spuler, 2015).